

NOURISH

An Eating Disorder
Recovery Journal

You deserve to eat.

You deserve to heal.

You deserve to live fully.

Daniel Tesfamariam

NOURISH

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This journal is not a substitute for professional ED treatment.

NEDA Helpline: 1-800-931-2237 | Crisis Text: Text NEDA to 741741

If you are in medical danger, go to the emergency room.

RECOVERY IS POSSIBLE

If you're holding this journal, part of you wants to recover.

That part - however small - is enough to begin.

Recovery means:

- Eating is not a moral issue
- Your body deserves nourishment
- You are more than a number on a scale
- Food is not the enemy - the ED is
- Slip-ups are part of recovery, not failure

This journal is a safe space. No calorie counts. No body measurements.

Just healing.

ED THOUGHTS vs HEALTHY THOUGHTS

Learning to tell the difference is key to recovery:

ED VOICE SAYS:

You don't deserve to eat

You'll get fat

Skip this meal

You're disgusting

No one will love you at that weight

Just one more day of restriction

You ate too much

RECOVERY VOICE SAYS:

Everyone deserves food

Your body needs fuel to live

Skipping makes it harder

You are worthy of love

Love isn't conditional on size

One more day hurts my recovery

I ate what my body needed

BODY IMAGE HEALING (1/3)

Things my body DOES for me (not how it looks):

- 1. _____
- 2. _____
- 3. _____
- 4. _____
- 5. _____
- 6. _____
- 7. _____
- 8. _____

Dear Body,

BODY IMAGE HEALING (3/3)

Body neutrality statements (not positive - just NEUTRAL):

- My body carries me through the day
- My body is doing its best
- I don't have to love my body to treat it well
- My worth is not determined by my appearance
- Bodies change. That's normal, not failure.

My own body neutral statements:

MEAL PLANNING WITHOUT FEAR (1/5)

Day: _____ Date: _____

Breakfast:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Morning Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Lunch:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Afternoon Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Dinner:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Evening Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

MEAL PLANNING WITHOUT FEAR (2/5)

Day: _____ Date: _____

Breakfast:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Morning Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Lunch:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Afternoon Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Dinner:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Evening Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

MEAL PLANNING WITHOUT FEAR (3/5)

Day: _____ Date: _____

Breakfast:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Morning Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Lunch:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Afternoon Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Dinner:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Evening Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

MEAL PLANNING WITHOUT FEAR (4/5)

Day: _____ Date: _____

Breakfast:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Morning Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Lunch:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Afternoon Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Dinner:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Evening Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

MEAL PLANNING WITHOUT FEAR (5/5)

Day: _____ Date: _____

Breakfast:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Morning Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Lunch:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Afternoon Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Dinner:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

Evening Snack:

What I ate: _____

How I felt before: _____ During: _____ After: _____

ED voice said: _____

Recovery voice said: _____

TRIGGER IDENTIFICATION

What triggers ED behaviors for me?

People: _____

Places: _____

Times of day: _____

Emotions: _____

Situations: _____

Social media/images: _____

My plan for when I'm triggered:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

COPING WITH URGES

When the urge hits, try these INSTEAD:

- Call someone from my support list
- Write in this journal
- Take a walk (not for burning calories - for fresh air)
- Put on a comfort show
- Hold ice cubes
- Do a body scan meditation
- Look at my 'reasons for recovery' page
- Text a friend
- Draw/paint/create something
- Read recovery affirmations
- Remind myself: the urge will pass in 15-20 minutes

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BODY GRATITUDE PRACTICE

Thank your body for what it DOES, not how it looks:

My hands: I'm grateful because _____

My legs: I'm grateful because _____

My heart: I'm grateful because _____

My brain: I'm grateful because _____

My stomach: I'm grateful because _____

My lungs: I'm grateful because _____

My voice: I'm grateful because _____

My arms: I'm grateful because _____

My eyes: I'm grateful because _____

My whole body: I'm grateful because _____

CHALLENGING FOOD RULES (1/3)

Food Rule #1:

The rule: _____

Where did it come from? _____

Evidence this rule is HELPING me: _____

Evidence this rule is HURTING me: _____

Challenge: What would happen if I broke this rule? _____

Did I break it? What happened? _____

Food Rule #2:

The rule: _____

Where did it come from? _____

Evidence this rule is HELPING me: _____

Evidence this rule is HURTING me: _____

Challenge: What would happen if I broke this rule? _____

Did I break it? What happened? _____

CHALLENGING FOOD RULES (2/3)

Food Rule #3:

The rule: _____

Where did it come from? _____

Evidence this rule is HELPING me: _____

Evidence this rule is HURTING me: _____

Challenge: What would happen if I broke this rule? _____

Did I break it? What happened? _____

Food Rule #4:

The rule: _____

Where did it come from? _____

Evidence this rule is HELPING me: _____

Evidence this rule is HURTING me: _____

Challenge: What would happen if I broke this rule? _____

Did I break it? What happened? _____

CHALLENGING FOOD RULES (3/3)

Food Rule #5:

The rule: _____

Where did it come from? _____

Evidence this rule is HELPING me: _____

Evidence this rule is HURTING me: _____

Challenge: What would happen if I broke this rule? _____

Did I break it? What happened? _____

Food Rule #6:

The rule: _____

Where did it come from? _____

Evidence this rule is HELPING me: _____

Evidence this rule is HURTING me: _____

Challenge: What would happen if I broke this rule? _____

Did I break it? What happened? _____

SOCIAL EATING PREPARATION

Eating with others can be hard. Let's plan ahead:

The event: _____

My fears about it: _____

My plan: I will eat _____ and that is ENOUGH.

If ED voice gets loud, I will: _____

Person who knows and can support me: _____

Reminder: Eating with others is NORMAL and I deserve to enjoy it.

WEEKLY RECOVERY CHECK-IN - Week 1

Week of: _____

Meals completed (aim for 3 meals + 2-3 snacks/day): ____ /day avg

ED urges this week (how many times): ____

Times I acted on the urge: ____ Times I resisted: ____

Coping skills I used: _____

Recovery wins this week:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Struggles this week: _____

Body image rating (1=terrible, 10=neutral/good): ____

One food rule I challenged: _____

Self-compassion moment: _____

WEEKLY RECOVERY CHECK-IN - Week 2

Week of: _____

Meals completed (aim for 3 meals + 2-3 snacks/day): ____ /day avg

ED urges this week (how many times): ____

Times I acted on the urge: ____ Times I resisted: ____

Coping skills I used: _____

Recovery wins this week:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Struggles this week: _____

Body image rating (1=terrible, 10=neutral/good): ____

One food rule I challenged: _____

Self-compassion moment: _____

WEEKLY RECOVERY CHECK-IN - Week 3

Week of: _____

Meals completed (aim for 3 meals + 2-3 snacks/day): ____ /day avg

ED urges this week (how many times): ____

Times I acted on the urge: ____ Times I resisted: ____

Coping skills I used: _____

Recovery wins this week:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Struggles this week: _____

Body image rating (1=terrible, 10=neutral/good): ____

One food rule I challenged: _____

Self-compassion moment: _____

WEEKLY RECOVERY CHECK-IN - Week 4

Week of: _____

Meals completed (aim for 3 meals + 2-3 snacks/day): ____ /day avg

ED urges this week (how many times): ____

Times I acted on the urge: ____ Times I resisted: ____

Coping skills I used: _____

Recovery wins this week:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Struggles this week: _____

Body image rating (1=terrible, 10=neutral/good): ____

One food rule I challenged: _____

Self-compassion moment: _____

WEEKLY RECOVERY CHECK-IN - Week 5

Week of: _____

Meals completed (aim for 3 meals + 2-3 snacks/day): ____ /day avg

ED urges this week (how many times): ____

Times I acted on the urge: ____ Times I resisted: ____

Coping skills I used: _____

Recovery wins this week:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Struggles this week: _____

Body image rating (1=terrible, 10=neutral/good): ____

One food rule I challenged: _____

Self-compassion moment: _____

WEEKLY RECOVERY CHECK-IN - Week 6

Week of: _____

Meals completed (aim for 3 meals + 2-3 snacks/day): ____ /day avg

ED urges this week (how many times): ____

Times I acted on the urge: ____ Times I resisted: ____

Coping skills I used: _____

Recovery wins this week:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Struggles this week: _____

Body image rating (1=terrible, 10=neutral/good): ____

One food rule I challenged: _____

Self-compassion moment: _____

WEEKLY RECOVERY CHECK-IN - Week 7

Week of: _____

Meals completed (aim for 3 meals + 2-3 snacks/day): ____ /day avg

ED urges this week (how many times): ____

Times I acted on the urge: ____ Times I resisted: ____

Coping skills I used: _____

Recovery wins this week:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Struggles this week: _____

Body image rating (1=terrible, 10=neutral/good): ____

One food rule I challenged: _____

Self-compassion moment: _____

WEEKLY RECOVERY CHECK-IN - Week 8

Week of: _____

Meals completed (aim for 3 meals + 2-3 snacks/day): ____ /day avg

ED urges this week (how many times): ____

Times I acted on the urge: ____ Times I resisted: ____

Coping skills I used: _____

Recovery wins this week:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Struggles this week: _____

Body image rating (1=terrible, 10=neutral/good): ____

One food rule I challenged: _____

Self-compassion moment: _____

MY REASONS FOR RECOVERY

When the ED voice is loud, read this page:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____

I am recovering for ME. Not to be thin. Not for others.

I am recovering to LIVE.

Date: _____ With: _____ Notes: _____

RECOVERY MILESTONES CELEBRATION

- | | |
|---|-------------|
| ☐ Ate a fear food | Date: _____ |
| ☐ Ate without counting | Date: _____ |
| ☐ Ate in public | Date: _____ |
| ☐ Went a full day without ED behaviors | Date: _____ |
| ☐ Looked in mirror without criticizing | Date: _____ |
| ☐ Wore something I was scared to wear | Date: _____ |
| ☐ Ate when hungry (honored my body) | Date: _____ |
| ☐ Told someone about my ED | Date: _____ |
| ☐ Went a full week without behaviors | Date: _____ |
| ☐ Chose recovery over the ED voice | Date: _____ |

You are doing the hardest, bravest thing. Keep going.